

TypeMyworDz human-work guidelines

A practical reference for proofreading and human transcription requests. These standards apply unless a client brief expressly says otherwise.

1. The TypeMyworDz standard

A transcript is a written record of spoken audio, not a summary or a rewrite. Preserve the speaker's meaning, wording, order, tone, and uncertainty. Do not silently paraphrase, repair grammar, add explanations, or invent words. Accuracy comes before speed, and every submission must receive a complete review before delivery.

2. Full verbatim and clean verbatim

Full verbatim includes speech errors, false starts, fillers, slang, stutters, repetitions, and unfinished wording. Clean verbatim removes clear fillers, stutters, speech errors, false starts, unnecessary repetitions, and explicit self-corrections while preserving meaning. Do not change an intact sentence simply because it sounds informal. Follow the client brief when it specifies the style.

3. Do not paraphrase or correct the speaker

Do not reconstruct a sentence into better English, change a speaker's grammar, or replace spoken wording with a more professional alternative unless the applicable client brief expressly requires it. Preserve contractions as spoken. Curse words are transcribed as spoken. Direct quotations use straight double quotation marks.

4. Inaudible, unintelligible, and timestamps

Use [inaudible 00:00:00] when the sound cannot be heard. Use [unintelligible 00:00:00] when speech can be heard but cannot be understood. Use timestamps in [00:00:00] format. Do not use parentheses in place of square brackets. Check the audio before marking a passage and place the notation as close as possible to the uncertain words.

5. Paragraphs, punctuation, and capitalization

Split long speeches into readable paragraphs without changing the speaker's order. Normally end every sentence with punctuation and capitalize the beginning of every sentence. Do not use exclamation marks in transcripts. Preserve question marks when the speaker asks a question. Never add punctuation that changes the intended meaning.

6. Speaker labels and changes

Use descriptive speaker labels when the assignment requires labels. Labels should be bold, followed by a colon and one space, for example, **Interviewer:** and **Participant:** . Separate speaker changes as accurately as possible. When identity is uncertain, replay the exchange and flag the uncertainty instead of guessing.

7. Sound events and interruptions

Use concise, lower-case bracketed notes for relevant sound events, such as [laughs], [background noise], [crosstalk], [silence], and [sound cut]. Use a double dash for a false start, speech error, or unfinished sentence. Use a single dash for an interruption where the speaker continues. Do not over-describe ordinary room sounds.

8. Numbers, dates, and times

Generally spell out single-digit numbers and use numerals for larger numbers. Use numerals for money, years, ages, percentages, measurements, equations, dates, times, telephone numbers, and mixed-number sentences when the context calls for them. Write percent in transcript text unless a client brief says otherwise. Use capitalized AM and PM for times. Formal series remain capitalized, such as Grade 8, Section B, Chapter 1, and Article VI.

9. Names, research, and consistency

Research distinctive proper nouns, organisations, places, technical terms, and titles when appropriate. Research verifies spelling and context; it does not authorize changing the speaker's wording or adding information. Keep confirmed spellings consistent throughout the transcript and ask the admin when two possible identities cannot be resolved.

10. Privacy, review, and delivery

Treat every recording, transcript, name, and client instruction as confidential. Use approved tools and do not share files casually. Before delivery, check the brief, completeness, speaker turns, timestamps, uncertain passages, names, numbers, punctuation, and formatting from beginning to end. Submit work only when another person can use it without needing to reconstruct what you meant.

Practical examples

Clean verbatim

Spoken: "I, I think we should— we should leave now."

Clean: "I think we should leave now." Do not add a reason or rewrite the sentence.

Full verbatim

Spoken: "Um, I, I think we should— we should leave now."

Full: "Um, I, I think we should— we should leave now." Keep the spoken features when the brief requests full verbatim.

Uncertainty

If a word cannot be heard, use [inaudible 00:01:14]. If the sound is present but the words cannot be understood, use [unintelligible 00:01:14].

Interruption

Use a single dash when a second speaker interrupts and the first speaker continues. Use a double dash for a false start or unfinished thought.

Research

If a speaker says a distinctive company or place name, replay it, research the likely spelling, and keep it consistent. Do not add information that was not spoken.

Numbers and time quick reference

- Spell out ordinary single-digit counts: one, two, three times a week.
- Use numerals for money, years, ages, percentages, measurements, equations, dates, times, telephone numbers, and mixed-number sentences when applicable.
- Use 9:30 AM and 4:15 PM, with capitalized AM and PM.
- Keep formal series capitalized: Grade 8, Section B, Chapter 1, Article VI.
- Follow a client brief when it gives a more specific number or formatting rule.

Final submission checklist

- Read the client brief a second time.
- Replay every uncertain word, name, speaker change, and timestamp.
- Check punctuation, capitalization, numbers, and paragraph breaks.
- Confirm the transcript is complete from the beginning to the end of the audio.
- Remove internal notes and unnecessary commentary.
- Submit through the approved TypeMyworDz workflow and keep the source confidential.

Before you submit

If you are not sure, flag the uncertainty rather than guessing. A careful question to the admin is part of professional transcription work.